

The `allowedTools` parameter specifies which tools can execute automatically without prompting the user for permission, providing a security whitelist for trusted operations. It accepts the same syntax as `tools`—built-in tool names (`"read"`), specific MCP tools (`"@server_name/tool_name"`), or server-wide access (`"@server_name"`)—but notably does **not** support the `"*"` wildcard for security reasons.

Tools must be listed in both `tools` (for visibility) and `allowedTools` (for auto-approval) to execute without user confirmation, while tools in `tools` but not in `allowedTools` will prompt the user before execution, and `toolsSettings` can still apply additional restrictions even to allowed tools.

Objective

Learn how to use `allowedTools` to automatically approve specific tools without user prompts.

Instructions

Step 1: Create Agent with Auto-Approved Tools

```
1 cat > .kiro/agents/auto-approved-dev.json << 'EOF'
2 {
3   "name": "auto-approved-dev",
4   "description": "Development assistant with some auto-approved tools",
5   "tools": ["read", "write", "shell"],
6   "allowedTools": ["read"]
7 }
8 EOF
```



Step 2: Create Agent with Multiple Auto-Approved Tools

```
1 cat > .kiro/agents/multi-approved-dev.json << 'EOF'
2 {
3   "name": "multi-approved-dev",
4   "description": "Development assistant with multiple auto-approved tools",
5   "tools": ["read", "write", "shell"],
6   "allowedTools": ["read", "write"]
7 }
8 EOF
```



Step 3: Test Auto-Approval Behavior

1. Test Single Auto-Approved Tool:

```
1 kiro-cli chat --agent auto-approved-dev
```



Try these commands:

"Read the README.md file"	# Should work without prompt
"Create a test file with some content"	# Should ask for permission
"Run 'ping 127.0.0.1' command"	# Should ask for permission

2. Test Multiple Auto-Approved Tools:

```
1 kiro-cli chat --agent multi-approved-dev
```



Try the same commands:

"Read the README.md file"	# Should work without prompt
"Create a test file with some content"	# Should work without prompt
"Run 'ping 127.0.0.1' command"	# Should ask for permission

Verification

- ✓ Auto-approved tools work without user prompts
- ✓ Non-approved tools still require permission
- ✓ Multiple tools can be auto-approved simultaneously
- ✓ Tool must be in `tools` list to be auto-approved

Key Learnings

- `allowedTools` enables automatic approval for specific tools
- Tools must be listed in both `tools` and `allowedTools` to work automatically
- Auto-approval improves workflow efficiency for trusted operations
- Security balance: approve safe tools, prompt for potentially dangerous ones